

# Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · [contact@mbeardwell.com](mailto:contact@mbeardwell.com) · [mbeardwell.com](http://mbeardwell.com)  
[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

## Professional Summary

Security Analyst with strengths in digital forensics and OSINT. Experience includes ARM instruction patching and binary analysis. Recovered deleted data and artefacts in both lab-based and real-world contexts. Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs, Top 2% TryHackMe) and earned a First-Class BSc in Computer Science from King's College London. Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+.

## Technical Skills

- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM Assembly
- **Networking:** Wireshark, TCP/IP analysis, PCAP inspection
- **Forensics:** Autopsy, dd, foremost, photorec, scalpel; disk image recovery and file carving
- **OSINT:** Identity/location tracing, metadata correlation, client investigations, toolkit authoring
- **Reverse Engineering:** GDB, IDA Free, Ghidra, radare2, ARM runtime patching

## Cybersecurity Projects

**ActiveReconLite** · *Python Port Scanner* FEB 2025 – MAR 2025  
Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Outperforms Nmap in some cases by 60x; scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap's 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning. [github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite](https://github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite)

**Location and Identity Resolution from Minimal Public Signals** · *OSINT Case Study* APR 2025  
Tracked real-world identity from anonymised YouTube uploads using public data. Shows attacker thinking, threat profiling, and privacy risk awareness. Demonstrates threat intelligence process fundamentals: collection, enrichment, analysis, and attribution based on minimal public indicators. [github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study](https://github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study)

**UK Person-centric OSINT Toolkit** JUN 2025  
Curation of UK-only, legal person-focused OSINT resources for investigative use. Featured by "Learn Cybersecurity" Telegram channel (27k subscribers); 100+ LinkedIn/Substack clicks in 1 week. [github.com/mbeardwell/uk-personal-os](https://github.com/mbeardwell/uk-personal-osint)

**Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs** · *Bachelor's Thesis* OCT 2022 – MAY 2023  
Developed PoC mimicking evasive malware behaviour by changing programs in memory at the lowest level. [github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu](https://github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu)

## Professional Experience

**OSINT Investigator** · *Freelance & Self-Led* MAY 2023 – APR 2025  
Conducted multiple open-ended OSINT investigations for clients, including one extensively documented case study. Also independently executed identity and geolocation tracing projects.

**Maths Tutor** · *Freelance* SEP 2016 – NOV 2019  
Tutored students aged 9–13 in maths (11+ and GCSE prep).

**Research and Documentation Intern** · *Indo UK Institute of Health* JUN 2017 – AUG 2017  
Researched benefits/partnerships and edited exec-level strategy docs for a billion-pound healthcare initiative.

## Education and Certifications

**Security Training** · *TryHackMe* FEB 2022 – PRESENT  
Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs) that included digital forensics, OSINT, and reverse engineering. Ranked in the Top 2% globally.

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|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------|
| <b>BSc (Hons) CS</b> · <i>King's College London</i> | First-Class | SEP 2018 – JUL 2023 |
| <b>A-Levels</b> · <i>King's Maths School</i>        | A* A* A* A* | SEP 2016 – JUL 2018 |

|                    |                                          |                     |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| CompTIA            | Security+                                | (IN PROGRESS)       |
| TryHackMe          | Intro to Cyber Security                  | FEB 2024            |
| Security Blue Team | Intro to OSINT                           | JUN 2025            |
| TryHackMe          | Pre-Security                             | APR 2022            |
| Prince's Trust     | TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid) | JAN 2024 – APR 2024 |